

Enhanced PRISM Features Implementation Report - Phase II

*TA-10065 REG: Development of
Pacific Power Utilities Reform Network*

Asian Development Bank
Pacific Power Association

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ABBREVIATIONS

ADB Asian Development Bank

SECTION 1 INTRODUCTION

Add credit appraisal capabilities somewhere

Commented [JH1]: Jaime

SECTION 2 AI-DRIVEN PRISM PLATFORM

Commented [JH2]: Eugene

2.1 DATABASE MIGRATION

PRISM AI needed a database that supports vectorization and Postgres is the best candidate for that because it battle-tested, opensource and easy to migrate to from MySQL. The Supabase self-hosted open source package provides a nice graphical user interface to manage Postgres.

2.2 APPLICATION RE-DESIGN FOR AI READABILITY

eugene

2.3 AI SDK AND MODEL SELECTION

Vercel AI SDK is the best when it comes to building AI applications. The Prism web application is built on Next.js, also a product of Vercel, so the AI SDK fits perfectly into it. The Anthropic Claude family of models, while it is as good as models from other providers like OpenAI, provides us with power and flexibility that we need for PRISM AI.

2.4 AI TOOLING ARCHITECTURE

A set of tools (pieces of code that PRISM AI can run) were built to help the AI do achieve what we needed. Some of the main ones are:

- Database Connector
- Natural language-to-SQL translation
- Input retrieval and KPI calculations
- Dynamic AI response visualization
- Direct connection to the Power BI Dashboard data and semantic model

2.5 CONVERSATIONAL AI

Uses conversational tools to create natural language responses based on the results of data queries.

2.6 GENERATIVE AI

In addition to conversational tools, PRISM AI has generative tools that enable PRISM AI to generate responses in various formats needed to clearly communicate its responses to the user.

2.7 PREDICTIVE AI

The analytical tools built into PRISM AI enable it to see trends in the data and make predictions.

2.8 AI ACCURACY TESTING

we can only complete this section when the formula builder is done...building it right now

Taia and Eugene and Krissy

SECTION 3 EXPANDED DATA COLLECTION

3.1 NEW KPIS

3.1.1 RENEWABLE ENERGY & ENERGY STORAGE KPIS

eugene

3.1.2 PERFORMANCE RATIO, FTE WORKED HOURS, FTE PAID HOURS

eugene

3.2 CUSTOM KPI FUNCTIONALITY

Eugene –

- limited to using existing measures
- Private or shared
- Reviewed by BMO

3.3 CHANGES IN KPI WORKFLOW

Eugene

- Time series alignment
- Can enter targets from BSC or from ???

3.4 METADATA FRAMEWORK CHANGES

Not sure yet what goes here....eugene

Commented [JH3]: Jaime with inputs from Eugene (which KPIs were added, formulas).

Commented [JH4]: Eugene

Commented [JH5]: Eugene

Commented [JH6]: Eugene

SECTION 4 DATA ENTRY & VALIDATION ENHANCEMENTS

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4.1 DIRECT WEB-APP ENTRY / RETIREMENT OF DATA COLLECTION WORKBOOK

Taia first, then eugene

- Retirement of Excel DCW
- New Excel templates –
 - category or sub-category locked
 - download/uploads
 - data entry and comments only by utilities

We've retired the DCW (Data Collection Worksheet) to simplify the data entry user journey. PRISM 2 comes with a new and simplified data entry UI that divides the whole journey into separate views based on categories and sub-categories of inputs.

4.2 BUSINESS VALIDATION LOGIC AND AUTO-COMPLETION

Taia first, then eugene

- How will these be applied in p2
- Test results

4.3 FILTERS AND NAVIGATION IMPROVEMENTS

Taia first, then eugene

- new UI
 - generators
 - relevance
 - data entry status and clickable links on counts
- new Filters
 -

SECTION 5 **BALANCED SCORECARD** INTEGRATION

5.1 BSC FRAMEWORK IMPLEMENTATION AND **STRATEGY MAPS**

eugene

5.2 UTILITY-SPECIFIC AND CUSTOM KPI SELECTION/TRACKING

eugene

Commented [JH8]: Jaime with inputs from Eugene (what was finally developed, what are the main functionalities, screenshots).

SECTION 6 DATA VISUALIZATION ENHANCEMENTS

Commented [JH9]: Krissy, please add the enhancements here as subheadings. We can add the ones that will be ready by August 28th here and any outstanding ones in Section 9.

SECTION 7 CYBERSECURITY & ACCESS CONTROL

Commented [JH10]: Eugene

7.1 ROLE-BASED ACCESS CONTROL WITH DELEGATION

Taia first then eugene

7.2 ENCRYPTION/IDENTITY-DATA PROTECTIONS

Taia first then eugene

7.3 SECURE API ARCHITECTURE AND SYSTEM REGISTRATION

Taia first then eugene

SECTION 8 COMMERCIAL SUSTAINABILITY FRAMEWORK

This section sets out the commercial sustainability framework developed for PRISM 2.0, drawing on market evidence to assess whether the platform can cover the cost of its own operation. Section 8.1 presents the main findings of the market sounding exercise, summarizing the demand for PRISM among non-member users (MDBs, regulators, and energy consultants) and their willingness to pay under the different access options tested. Section 8.2 translates those findings into the proposed tiered access and subscription options, describing the three subscription options together with their pricing and associated access rights. Section 8.3 then presents the results of the revenue and expense model, describing the underlying revenue and cost assumptions and projecting PRISM's annual revenue and end-of-year cash position over a five-year horizon under two scenarios—one excluding and one including the salary of PPA's dedicated benchmarking (BMO) staff position.

8.1 MARKET SOUNDING FINDINGS (NON-MEMBER DEMAND)

To begin the market sounding exercise, a survey was designed to assess the market demand and commercial viability of PRISM.¹ The objective of the survey was to collect feedback from multilateral development banks (MDBs), regulators, energy consultants, investors, and academic institutions on what utility data they need, how they currently access it, the value they would place on PRISM's features, and their willingness to pay for different access models. It also explored preferred pricing and procurement arrangements, potential additional services, concerns about subscribing, and interest in pilot participation or co-investment. The subscription options presented to survey respondents were the following:

- **Option 1: Basic Tier** would provide access to annual benchmarking reports in PDF format, view-only access to summary dashboards, and a limited KPI dataset covering key operational and financial indicators, as well as regional aggregated data. This tier would support up to five user accounts and is estimated to cost USD 2,000–3,000 per year.
- **Option 2: Premium Tier** would provide full access to the PRISM dashboards, including interactive filters, the complete KPI database covering 365 inputs and 136 indicators, and downloadable datasets. The subscription would support up to ten user accounts and include email support. The estimated annual price would be USD 3,000–5,000.
- **Option 3: Pay-per-Project Access** would provide full access to the platform for a defined period, with all features available during the access period, including downloadable datasets for offline use. Access would be available for up to three users and would include email support. This option would provide a 90-day access period, priced at approximately USD 400–600 per project, equivalent to roughly one-quarter of the annual Premium Tier subscription.

The market sounding gathered responses from 10 multilateral development banks (MDBs) and regulator organizations, and five energy consulting and research firms. From the first group, eight are Pacific energy regulators or government bodies (Fijian Competition and Consumer Commission, Tonga Energy Commission,

¹ Appendix A contains a detailed analysis of the survey responses.

Palau Energy & Water Administration, FSM Department of Resources & Development, Government of Niue, Office of the Regulator, and Pacific Community/SPC), with only World Bank and ADB as MDBs.

MDBs and regulators were identified as the more commercially promising segment. Option 1 at USD 2,000–3,000 per year got 63 percent positive response. Option 3 at USD 400–600/project also gets 63 percent positive and has higher "very likely" intent (38 percent vs 25 percent). Option 2 at USD 3,000–5,000 per year drops to 38 percent positive. The response "none at these price points" got 38 percent of respondents for this group, reflecting the budget constraints of Pacific regulators.

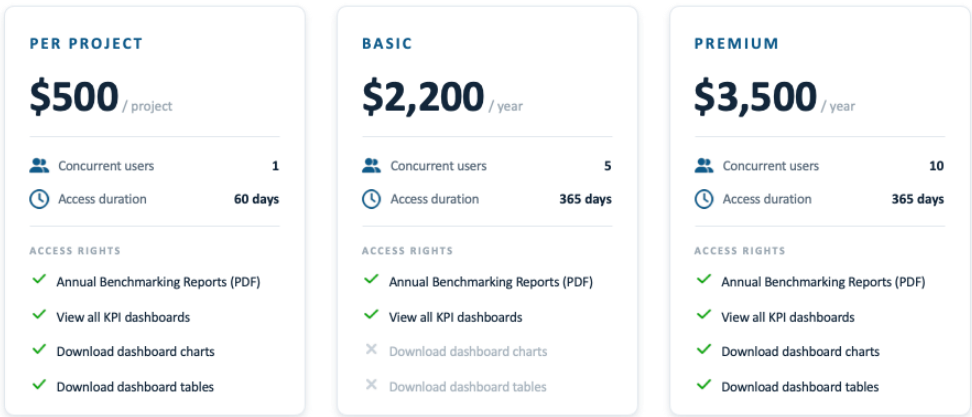
Energy Consultants seem resistant to annual subscriptions (USD 2,000–3,000 per year gets 75 percent "unlikely" or "very unlikely"). Option 3 at USD 400–600/project is the only viable model, with the option "somewhat likely" getting 50 percent of responses. The feature priority for this group of respondents is data download (Excel/CSV), which was rated "Critical" by 100 percent of respondents.

The biggest commercial risk identified by the survey is that nobody currently pays for a similar subscription. Open-text responses confirm the must-have conditions: complete Pacific utility coverage, reliable and up-to-date data, and strong institutional endorsement.

8.2 TIERED ACCESS AND SUBSCRIPTION OPTIONS

Based on the survey results, three subscription options were presented to PPA and will be incorporated into PRISM 2.0. Pricing was set at the lower end of the price ranges presented for the three options in the survey. The access period for Option 3 (Pay-per-Project Access) was adjusted to 60 days to provide similar value for money to Option 2 (Premium Tier), given the similar access rights offered by both options. The components and access rights of the three subscription options are shown in Figure 8.1.

Figure 8.1: Proposed Subscription Models



As suggested by PPA, these subscription options, pricing, and access rights will be further discussed and validated with PPA and donors during the PPA Annual Meetings in Fiji in November 2026.

8.3 REVENUE AND EXPENSE MODEL RESULTS

The model prepared for this analysis projects income and expenditure on a monthly basis over a five-year horizon beginning in January 2027, and reports the resulting annual revenue and end-of-year cash position. The projections use a “Moderate” scenario derived from the market-sounding exercise. Two funding scenarios were then modelled to isolate the effect of carrying a dedicated in-house benchmarking staff position: one that excludes PPA’s BMO salary and one that includes it. The revenue and platform-cost assumptions are identical across the two scenarios; the only difference is whether the BMO salary is charged to the platform.

8.3.1 REVENUE ASSUMPTIONS

Revenue is generated entirely from paid platform subscriptions; access for PPA members remains free of charge and unchanged. Under the recommended tier structure, and consistent with the willingness-to-pay signaled in the market sounding, the Moderate scenario assumes the following uptake and pricing, held flat across all five years:

- **Option 1—Basic Tier:** Five subscribers per year at USD 2,200, generating USD 11,000 per year. Aimed at smaller donors and regulators.
- **Option 2—Premium Tier:** Three subscribers per year at USD 3,500, generating USD 10,500 per year. Aimed at major MDBs and bilateral donors.
- **Option 3—Pay-per-Project Access:** Eight project accesses per year at USD 500 per 60-day window, generating USD 4,000 per year. Aimed at energy-sector consultants and, possibly, academic institutions.

Together these tiers produce total annual subscription revenue of USD 25,500, or USD 127,500 over the five-year horizon. As a deliberately conservative test of self-sufficiency, this run assumes no other income: annual PPA member contributions and any ADB or donor grant were both set to zero, so the platform is required to cover its costs from subscription revenue alone.

8.3.2 COST ASSUMPTIONS

Operating costs comprise two components: technical support and platform subscriptions (the third-party software and hosting services required to run the platform). Labor is costed at USD 50 per hour across the technical-support components, which include application support for the web application and the PowerBI environment, software-environment monitoring, updates and bug fixes, and maintenance of the knowledge base and documentation.

- **Technical support:** USD 19,845 in Year 1 and USD 14,862 per year in Years 2 to 5. Year 1 is higher because additional user support is expected immediately after go-live.
- **Platform subscriptions:** USD 4,804 per year, flat across the horizon, based on 12-month billing plans. This covers cloud hosting and daily backups, Microsoft Fabric, PowerBI Premium and Pro licenses, the analytics and help-desk tools, and the domain and security certificate.

Excluding the BMO salary, total operating costs are therefore USD 24,649 in Year 1 and USD 19,665 per year thereafter, or USD 103,310 over five years. The second scenario adds the salary of a dedicated BMO position at USD 22,800 per year (USD 1,900 per month), held flat across the horizon.

8.3.3 RESULTS

Table 8.1 below summarizes annual revenue and the end-of-year cash position for both scenarios. “Net cash flow” is revenue less costs within each year; the “cumulative cash balance” is the running position at each year-end, which is the key indicator of whether the platform stays solvent.

Table 8.1: Project Risks and Mitigation Measures

USD	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Year 4	Year 5	5-Year Total
Annual subscription revenue	25,500	25,500	25,500	25,500	25,500	127,500
Scenario 1 — Excluding BMO salary						
Operating costs	24,649	19,665	19,665	19,665	19,665	103,310
Net cash flow	851	5,835	5,835	5,835	5,835	24,190
Cumulative cash balance (year-end)	851	6,686	12,521	18,355	24,190	-
Scenario 2 — Including BMO salary						
Operating costs	47,449	42,465	42,465	42,465	42,465	217,310
Net cash flow	(21,949)	(16,965)	(16,965)	(16,965)	(16,965)	(89,810)
Cumulative cash balance (year-end)	(21,949)	(38,914)	(55,879)	(72,845)	(89,810)	-

Excluding the BMO salary, the platform is self-sustaining based on the assumptions for Scenario 1. Cumulative cash flow stays positive in every month of the five-year horizon. The tightest point is at the end of Year 1, when the balance falls to about USD 850 after paying for the higher first-year support costs. From Year 2 onward the platform generates a steady annual surplus of USD 5,835, closing Year 5 with a cumulative surplus of about USD 24,000.

The platform is not self-sustaining on subscription revenue alone if the BMO salary is included. The additional USD 22,800 per year pushes annual costs above income, and cumulative cash flow turns negative in Month 6 of Year 1. The shortfall increased by roughly USD 17,000 each year, reaching a cumulative deficit of about USD 90,000 by the end of Year 5..

8.4 BUILDING TIERED ACCESS CAPABILITY

eugene

SECTION 9 OUTSTANDING ITEMS

Commented [JH11]: Jaime/Eugene/Krissy

- Defined cybersecurity, confidentiality, and data privacy protocols fully integrated within PRISM's operational environment
- Commercial sustainability framework implementation (BMO staffing arrangements, tiered user access and subscription models, and validated financial management and payment gateway processing procedures, where endorsed by PPA),
- AI prompt engineering training materials and workshop documentation for PPA staff capacity building
- Training on Data Entry, KPIs, BSC, visualization and AI capabilities (from Work Plan)
- Formalized board and regulatory reporting templates integrated within the PRISM platform.

APPENDIX A ANALYSIS OF SURVEY RESPONSES

A.1 RESPONDENT PROFILES

MDBs and Regulators (n = 10)

- **Organization type:** 20% Multilateral Development Banks (World Bank, ADB); 80% "Other" – national energy regulators, energy ministries, and regional bodies
- **Geographic focus:** 50% Pacific Islands specifically; 20% Global; 10% Asia-Pacific; 20% Other
- **Sector coverage:** 100% Energy/Power; 70% Water & Sanitation; 50% Transport; 40% Telecommunications and Climate
- **Engagement intensity:** 40% daily or weekly; 30% ad-hoc or project-based
- **Data frequency needed:** 44% quarterly; 33% annually

The regulator-heavy composition is significant. Regulators have a direct, ongoing mandate to monitor utility performance, which makes them more natural recurring users than project-based MDB staff. However, Pacific Island regulators typically operate with constrained budgets and may require grant-funded access mechanisms.

Energy Consultants and Researchers (n = 4)

- **Organization type:** 50% regional Pacific-focused consulting firms; 25% specialized energy firms; 25% multi-sector firms with energy practice
- **Organization size:** 50% 21–50 staff; 50% 100+ staff – established professional firms, not freelancers
- **Geographic focus:** 75% Asia-Pacific; 25% Global
- **Engagement pattern:** 75% ad-hoc or project-based – episodic data needs
- **Primary clients:** 100% serve both Pacific power utilities and development banks.

A.2 DATA NEEDS AND USE CASES

What data these users need

- **MDBs/Regulators – top data needs (n=9 answered)**
 - Tariff structures and affordability analysis (100%)
 - Renewable energy integration levels (100%)
 - Operational performance indicators – generation, transmission, distribution (89%)
 - Financial performance metrics (78%)
 - Grid reliability metrics – SAIDI/SAIFI (67%)
 - Governance and institutional arrangements (67%)
 - Comparative/benchmarking data (67%)
 - Capital investment and asset management data (56%)
 - Credit risk and financial sustainability indicators (56%)
- **Energy Consultants – top data needs**
 - Operational performance indicators (100%)
 - Renewable energy integration (100%)
 - Grid reliability metrics – SAIDI/SAIFI (100%)
 - Capital investment and asset management data (75%)

- Comparative/benchmarking data (75%)
- Financial performance metrics (50%)

Implication: PRISM's existing KPI set already addresses the majority of what both segments need. The value proposition is primarily around access, standardization, and reliability of data that already exists in PRISM.

How these users currently get the data

- **MDBs/Regulators**
 - Government and regulatory authority reports (67%)
 - Direct requests to utilities (67%)
 - Consultants commissioned for data collection (56%)
 - PPA annual benchmarking reports (44%)
 - No systematic access — ad-hoc (11%)
- **Energy Consultants**
 - Direct requests to utilities (75%)
 - Government/regulatory authority reports (75%)
 - PPA annual benchmarking reports (75%)
 - Partner organizations (75%)
 - No systematic access — ad-hoc (75%)

Implication: Both segments already know PPA's benchmarking reports. Consultants rely heavily on patchwork, ad-hoc access. PRISM's competitive opening is offering something that does not currently exist in structured form.

Key use cases driving demand

- **MDBs/Regulators (n=9 answered)**
 - Portfolio monitoring and evaluation (89%)
 - Policy dialogue and sector strategy development (78%)
 - Project appraisal and due diligence (67%)
 - Technical assistance design (67%)
 - Country programming and allocation decisions (56%)
 - Climate finance and renewable energy investments (56%)
 - Knowledge products and research (56%)
 - Private sector investment facilitation (44%)
- **Energy Consultants**
 - Feasibility studies for new generation or grid projects (100%)
 - Technical assistance and capacity building programs (100%)
 - Utility performance assessments and diagnostics (75%)
 - Tariff studies and cost-of-service analysis (75%)
 - Strategic planning and business plan development (75%)
 - Climate finance and renewable energy projects (75%)

A.3 MAIN BARRIERS TO DATA ACCESS — STATUS QUO PAIN POINTS

Both segments ranked their data access challenges. Results are highly consistent across groups:

Challenge	MDB/Reg. Score	Consultant Score	Combined Rank
Data is not available or difficult to obtain	7.38	6.20	1st
Data quality/reliability concerns	6.75	6.60	2nd
Data is not standardized across utilities	6.00	4.60	3rd
Data is outdated by the time it's available	4.63	5.00	4th
Cost of data collection is prohibitive	4.00	4.80	5th
Lack of comparative/benchmarking context	3.38	2.40	6th
Data is not granular enough	2.88	4.40	7th

Implication: The top three barriers (availability, quality, and standardization) are precisely what PRISM is designed to address. The data quality assurance workflow and transparent methodology are commercial prerequisites, not optional extras.

A.4 FEATURE PRIORITIES

MDBs/Regulators — feature importance (% rating Critical or Very Important, n=9)

Feature	Critical	Very Important	Combined
Tariff analysis and affordability calculators	67%	22%	89%
Financial sustainability indicators	44%	44%	89%
Standardized automated reports	56%	22%	78%
Renewable energy integration metrics	33%	44%	78%
Interactive dashboards and visualizations	22%	56%	78%
Governance and institutional quality metrics	22%	56%	78%
Dedicated technical support	11%	67%	78%
Downloadable datasets (Excel/CSV)	33%	33%	67%
Historical benchmarking data (annual)	33%	33%	67%
Custom report generation	33%	11%	44%

Energy Consultants — feature importance

Feature	Critical	Very Important	Combined
Downloadable datasets (Excel/CSV)	100%	0%	100%
Renewable energy integration metrics	50%	25%	75%
Custom report generation	25%	50%	75%

Historical benchmarking data (annual)	25%	25%	50%
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Critical implication for consultants: Data download is rated Critical by 100%—they want to extract data into their own models, not use PRISM's dashboards.

Critical implication for MDBs/Regulators: Tariff analysis, financial sustainability, and standardized automated reports lead at 89% combined importance—structured information to use directly, not raw data.

A.5 QUALITATIVE FINDINGS – OPEN-TEXT RESPONSES

Additional features that would make PRISM more valuable

Data quality, currency, and frequency

Multiple respondents called for higher-frequency updates (quarterly or monthly), historical trend tracking, and year-over-year comparisons. One respondent requested "high-frequency and up-to-date data" and "timely, high-quality and decision-ready insights." Another asked for user alerts when new data becomes available and integration with internal reporting systems.

Regulatory and sector-specific metrics

Demand for data beyond current PRISM coverage: electricity access rates, GHG emissions, urban vs. rural electrification percentages, generator and renewable energy capacity data, and compliance with AU/NZ standard specifications.

Usability and export functionality

Customizable dashboards with filter/sort/compare capabilities; drill-down access to granular data; robust export options (PDF, Excel, CSV); predictive insights or trend forecasting; and data definitions and methodology explanations.

What would make PRISM a "must-have"

- **Full reliable coverage:** Complete Pacific coverage.
- **Regulatory decision support:** One respondent added: "It is a useful tool but there should be a specific tool for the Energy Regulators in the Pacific." Must-have requires the platform to "truly support tariffs and regulatory decisions directly, enable credit benchmarking across island systems and provide timely, high-quality and decision-ready insights."
- **Actionable insights:** One respondent listed reliable data; broad coverage; standardized metrics; clear value for policy/regulation/planning; easy-to-use interface; actionable insights; regular updates; affordable cost; and strong peer/institutional endorsement.
- **Downloadable data:** One respondent's entire must-have answer was "downloadable data set" (a hard requirement across both MDB and consultant segments).
- **Free access:** One respondent wrote "FREE portal", which indicates price sensitivity among some possible users.

A.6 WILLINGNESS TO PAY ASSESSMENT

Current payment behavior

Neither segment currently pays for similar platforms:

- MDBs/Regulators: 56% No, 44% Not sure, 0% Yes
- Energy Consultants: 100% No

The market sounding indicates an unmonetized but high-need segment. Commercializing PRISM means creating a new payment habit, not capturing share from an existing market.

Subscription option preferences

Option	Description	Price Tested
Option 1	Annual subscription — Basic level	\$2,000–3,000 USD/year
Option 2	Annual subscription — Premium level	\$3,000–5,000 USD/year
Option 3	Project-based access	\$400–600 USD/project

MDBs/Regulators — likelihood of subscribing (n=8 answered)

- **Option 1 (\$2,000–3,000/year): 63% positive** (25% very likely + 38% somewhat likely)
- **Option 3 (\$400–600/project): 63% positive** (38% very likely + 25% somewhat likely) — tied with Option 1, with higher "very likely" intent
- **Option 2 (\$3,000–5,000/year): 38% positive** — significant drop-off confirming the ceiling is around \$3,000–4,000
- **Preferred tier (unprompted):** Premium 38%, None at these prices 38%, Basic 13%, Pay-per-project 13%

Energy Consultants — likelihood of subscribing

- **Option 1 (\$2,000–3,000/year):** 25% positive, 75% unlikely or very unlikely
- **Option 2 (\$3,000–5,000/year):** 25% positive, 75% unlikely or very unlikely
- **Option 3 (\$400–600/project):** 50% somewhat likely, 50% neutral — nobody was "very likely"
- **Preferred tier:** Pay-per-project 50%, Premium 25%, Custom/hybrid 25%

Payment structure preferences

MDBs/Regulators: Annual subscription with upfront payment (38%) and "other" arrangements (38%) equally preferred; quarterly and multi-year options at 13% each.

Energy Consultants: Pay-per-report model (50%) preferred, followed by annual upfront (25%).

APPENDIX B
